7.20 Forms of Communication

In a general way, communication can be of three broad types- oral, written and nonverbal.

A. Verbal communication

The verbal communication is a type of oral communication when in a message is transmitted through the word spoken.

In oral or verbal communications, information is given directly, either through face-to-face or through telephone, mobile phones or office intercom. Meetings, lectures, seminar, conferences, interviews are example of verbal communication. There are some points for the oral communication which can be summed up as follows:

Advantages:

- Saves time and money
- Provides personal touch
- Tends to be more effective as the feedback can be received immediately
- Doubts can be clarified on the spot
- Chances of understanding are better
- Provides greater flexibility

Disadvantages of Oral Communication:

- Oral communication suffers from some inherent limitations.
- It is not always feasible (as in the case of long distances and sometime beyond the network services).
- Not appropriate for lengthy or complicated conversation.
- Not suitable for keeping records
- It has no legal validity and hence lead to problems in certain situations.
- May have chances of misunderstanding.

B. Non-verbal communication

It refers to the clues we send to others all the time regarding our feelings and emotions, either knowingly or unknowingly through our facial expressions, gestures and body

Difference between Oral and Written Communication

Basis for comparison	Oral communication	Written communication
Meaning	Exchange of ideas, information and message through spoken words is oral communication.	Interchange of message, opinions, and information in written or printed form is written communication.
What is it?	Communication with the help of words of mouth.	Communication with the help of text.
Literacy	Not required at all.	Necessary for communication.
Transmission of message	Speedy	Slow
Proof	No record of communication is there.	Proper records of communication are present.
Feedback	Immediate feedback can be given	Feedback takes time.
Revision before delivering the message	Not possible	Possible
Probability of misunderstanding	Very high	Quite less.

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